



The pinecone's scales open in dry weather.



Scales are tightly shut in wet weather.

OPEN AND CLOSE

Pinecones are traditionally used to forecast the weather. Put a pinecone outdoors and watch what happens. It will open out in very dry weather and close up when it is damp.

Flower power

When you want to know what the weather will be like, look for the magic carpet flower. It grows in the wild in South Africa and is a popular garden plant elsewhere. The petals stay wide open in clear weather, but they close up when the sky grows dark.



Frog-cast

One way to tell if it's going to rain soon is to look out for frogs. They love to come out when it's damp. Since the air becomes humid before it rains, you may see more frogs around and you will know to expect rain.

